

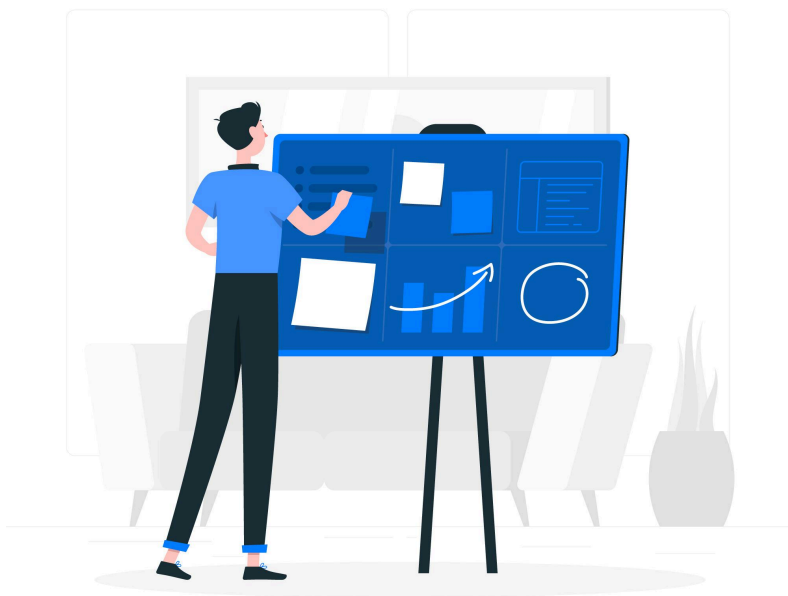
OSINT Investigation – Track a Cyber Criminal

1. General Description of the Task:

This project challenges participants to apply Open Source Intelligence (OSINT) techniques to investigate and trace the digital footprint of a known cybercriminal operating under the alias DarkWebX. The goal is to gather intelligence using only publicly available sources and tools, analyze their online presence, and generate a professional investigation report.

Participants will utilize tools such as Sherlock, theHarvester, and Google Dorking to uncover usernames, emails, social media profiles, and digital traces linked to the threat actor. The investigation extends to identifying whether their credentials have been compromised using breach checkers, and retrieving potential IP addresses from dark web forums or leaked logs.

All findings will be documented in a structured OSINT report, which may also include mappings to cybersecurity frameworks (e.g., MITRE ATT&CK), timelines, and threat attribution where possible. This hands-on experience provides real-world skills in cyber threat hunting, digital forensics, and ethical intelligence gathering.



2. Objectives:

- Investigate the digital footprint of a cybercriminal known as **DarkWebX**.
- Use OSINT (Open Source Intelligence) tools and techniques to collect publicly available data.
- Identify social media activity, email addresses, leaked credentials, and IP data.
- Generate a comprehensive investigation report.



3. Tools to be Used:

-  **Sherlock** – To discover associated social media accounts.
-  **theHarvester** – To collect email addresses and domain-related information.
-  **Google Dorking** – To find indexed hidden information.
-  **Have I Been Pwned Script/API** – To check for email breaches and leaked passwords. (Bonus)
-  **Web forums/log leaks** – To identify potential IP addresses.
-  **Markdown or PDF tools** – For report writing (e.g., Typora, MS Word, or Pandoc).



4-Requirements:

4-1- Identify Social Media Accounts

Requirement Details/Steps:

- Run Sherlock with the alias DarkWebX:
`python sherlock.py DarkWebX`
- Document all discovered platforms where DarkWebX has an account (e.g., Twitter, GitHub, forums).
- Validate if the accounts are active or dormant.

Deliverable of this Requirement:

- A list of verified social media accounts associated with DarkWebX.

4-2-Discover Associated Emails

Requirement Details/Steps:

- Use theHarvester to search email addresses:
`theHarvester -d hackerforums.net -l 100 -b google`
- Extract any discovered email addresses, especially those tied to forum posts or account registrations.

Deliverable of this Requirement:

- A list of identified email addresses used by DarkWebX (e.g., `darkwebx@protonmail.com`).

4-3-Check for Leaked Passwords (Bonus)

Requirement Details/Steps:

- Use `haveibeenpwned.py` or access the API to check for compromised email data:
`haveibeenpwned.py -e darkwebx@protonmail.com`
- Note down the number of breaches and any known passwords, if available.

Deliverable of this Requirement:

- Summary of email breach history and leaked credentials.

4-4- Track IP Addresses from Forum Logs

Requirement Details/Steps:

- Search past forum posts and dark web logs for any posted server logs or headers.
- Analyze logs for IP addresses linked to the user.
- Example finding: 45.67.89.23

Deliverable of this Requirement:

- IP addresses found and context (post/thread/log where found).

4-5-Generate OSINT Report

Requirement Details/Steps:

- Compile all findings into a single report.
- Include screenshots or snippets of findings.
- Organize report sections: Introduction, Methodology, Findings, and Conclusion.

Deliverable of this Requirement:

- Complete OSINT report in Markdown, PDF, or DOCX format.



5-Final Deliverables:

-  Verified social media account list
-  Extracted email address list
-  Summary of data breaches and leaked passwords
-  Traced IP addresses
-  Full OSINT investigation report

